Boundaries — Part 2 answer key

#	ID	Answer	Difficulty
2.1	a1555b5a-e2c7-4111-820a-85ed1923e629	D	Medium
2.2	87c679a7-fd47-4d88-a4f7-43658338277e	C	Medium
2.3	be33fee3-fb20-4b3e-9938-f3ad06edd6a6	D	Medium
2.4	b2c3cb5c-13f8-4a31-aad8-5741ce2817de	D	Medium
2.5	52f7b46f-3f44-4d76-8063-d928257b3164	B	Medium
2.6	9769fda4-5abb-4b85-9e45-26e6b0d6c2a2	B	Medium
2.7	26edb161-36c0-40ea-89cd-588e9b2b1f31	D	Medium
2.8	d330987d-701c-4103-b3d5-10c01e98bd35	C	Medium
2.9	df9bd545-dece-46fb-bf5b-f60931397f9c	C	Medium
2.10	cd06b390-9a40-4a9a-9f19-eaf6c6d27ea1	D	Medium
2.11	1272a41a-f321-46f0-8b6f-a016b8d2916a	D	Medium
2.12	dacdeae0-91cc-4045-b9ef-dc27fb85d045	C	Medium
2.13	0e6d7cb4-df03-41e3-a232-17a4230ba774	D	Medium
2.14	e0b53c52-f897-4582-b7de-f6e211e87ff7	C	Medium
2.15	e04cdf67-05e6-4aa1-9e20-580977e98de5	C	Medium
2.16	7fbbb4df-76bf-4c0d-86da-6076a653b90d	B	Medium
2.17	c8a945e1-d008-4cac-a824-603075e8000d	C	Medium
2.18	cc6d02b5-4af9-4aad-99c1-cff5d59bccce	C	Medium
2.19	d0d16783-ef40-445f-a4e1-a033a0b35daa	B	Medium
2.20	aa494bb3-a442-4bba-9a94-622b0297b91b	A	Medium
2.21	2ce12901-ba63-4561-9077-97d4b4b4fc47	C	Medium
2.22	078ae823-534c-4607-b015-b820dc16b66d	C	Medium

2.23	97d6d296-9094-426b-ac81-e4485adb17b9	C	Medium
2.24	9fd8c1e6-6968-406f-89b8-973c07fa9c4a	D	Medium
2.25	4b0deb5a-da7b-494d-a3f2-347dc606dfed	C	Medium
2.26	25a17e6b-87b8-4a28-bc40-b8d65e369837	C	Medium
2.27	007dd895-e4ed-4aa1-8414-06c33e6fd271	D	Medium
2.28	fd647ae7-ec37-4389-826c-c5e2146d2aa8	A	Medium
2.29	03a35c10-fe90-4240-9d2b-687104c00775	D	Medium
2.30	29a4c0f5-e4a7-4ae9-93fc-4c153df627f7	A	Medium
2.31	6178f63c-ef9a-4ece-8394-3d77620b7ff1	D	Medium
2.32	27832d9c-52c0-451d-9ea9-b7f14498c1fd	D	Medium
2.33	e5b71b6d-2901-4d56-b764-950afb57a96b	D	Medium
2.34	471d4144-80a4-4d23-a0c0-170823a91b45	D	Medium
2.35	87406695-3dc2-48da-8966-67b98464b498	B	Medium
2.36	8913313c-428a-4db4-a846-a2f0f3114e48	C	Medium
2.37	7730a558-40d3-432a-8bcd-518885d552d6	D	Medium
2.38	5aeac962-fa14-4491-8991-56ff0ec4b5c6	B	Medium
2.39	aafb7917-da63-4f45-a9cf-94812aae98f2	D	Medium
2.40	7242e88d-e335-4dc4-b9df-662c2488fc9b	B	Medium
2.41	8cd38df4-f96a-40f2-ae1b-0370ec32c3b7	A	Medium
2.42	589b6653-291c-4e0c-a944-65af9665c8bc	C	Medium
2.43	d99f186d-1906-41f6-a1df-00cd641b8ca2	C	Medium
2.44	ac4962dd-95b7-4b55-a625-8e38af6f3f37	C	Medium
2.45	f960db6c-ca24-4344-9627-af95fbefd793	A	Medium
2.46	194d3a74-1fe8-40f1-9cf1-f2ea63dfa463	C	Hard
2.47	d2dee6cb-c775-4f13-b8cd-a1e34eb70c1d	D	Hard
2.48	65b38c29-ee46-4237-ae07-31e809877121	D	Hard

2.49	3e8a570e-28ad-4084-ba82-389eb7175263	A	Hard
2.50	f60eab77-bd60-4227-a0f7-3a92bc6547e2	C	Hard
2.51	2e16f638-d480-4613-b60a-1efd039dcab1	D	Hard
2.52	ff4421fe-618a-4297-8a59-b8563e9330ce	A	Hard
2.53	27e6a792-7dd0-4c78-ae6f-67d2960ac1ac	D	Hard
2.54	8a9f9154-be7d-4115-914f-7de2a4e80f23	C	Hard
2.55	86a457d1-ec67-4057-85fc-50dbbcaeb40d	D	Hard
2.56	7cdef224-4daf-47ec-bf14-b5559cb48809	B	Hard
2.57	c45f8845-4c1e-45b6-a50b-2aef123bb12c	B	Hard
2.58	2b2c783d-0fb5-4589-bfab-c94cee0c2768	A	Hard
2.59	96cf0b06-0499-4f2a-aaff-0b3a2fd248db	A	Hard
2.60	e1514a4c-0079-4703-a68b-9704e381a0c9	B	Hard
2.61	97bbdc34-b086-4b64-bd7e-939f61ee8bc8	C	Hard
2.62	c19cd325-f2f3-411c-bb1d-88a70950991f	D	Hard
2.63	b864dc55-e802-40d8-9448-12e32f81e910	B	Hard
2.64	374b6ee6-bd5a-40f9-b43a-ba2c333d1945	C	Hard
2.65	d3e0c118-8d35-4130-945e-74f9c2cf9b27	C	Hard
2.66	195e23f6-ec4e-4d53-b072-1e61cd17d277	D	Hard
2.67	27dcef67-fa3b-4d14-8bc9-703bcc36b1b1	B	Hard
2.68	42ca5120-4c07-4e04-98e7-e2990f2fdebd	D	Hard
2.69	e03f7485-ceab-4c91-bc83-0288f4fc1e97	B	Hard
2.70	12d17397-3221-4a0e-8894-52e43b3a51af	C	Hard
2.71	b20a8ed2-86bb-455d-a1a5-7bdec6418766	D	Hard

Rationales

▼ 2.1 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The dash after "chloroplasts" pairs with the dash after "from light" to separate the supplementary element "the cellular organs that generate energy from light" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to define the term "chloroplasts," and the pair of dashes indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because a semicolon can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a comma can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.2 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The phrase "making…at the time" provides additional information about Cahokia that's not required for the sentence to make sense or function grammatically. As a nonessential supplement, this phrase should be separated from the rest of the sentence with a comma.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice results in a run-on sentence. The nonessential descriptive aside "making…at the time" needs to be separated from the rest of the sentence with a comma. Choice B is incorrect. This choice results in a sentence fragment. "Making…at the time" doesn't have a subject and can't stand on its own as a sentence. Thus, it can't be separated from the rest of the sentence with a period. Choice D is incorrect. This choice results in a punctuation error. "Making…at the time" doesn't have a subject and can't stand on its own as an independent clause. Since a semicolon can only link two independent clauses, using one here creates an error.

▼ 2.3 — D

Choice D is the best answer. "A combination of fiction and memoir, poetry and prose" is a nonessential supplement, so it needs to be set off from the rest of the sentence with a pair of matching punctuation marks. We already have a dash at the beginning of the supplement, so we need to add a dash at the end of the supplement to match.

Choice A is incorrect. This doesn't complete the text in a way that conforms to the conventions of Standard English. "A combination of fiction and memoir, poetry and prose" is a nonessential supplement, so it needs to be set off from the rest of the sentence with a

pair of matching punctuation marks. We already have a dash at the beginning of the supplement, so we need to add a dash at the end of the supplement to match. Choice B is incorrect. This doesn't complete the text in a way that conforms to the conventions of Standard English. "A combination of fiction and memoir, poetry and prose" is a nonessential supplement, so it needs to be set off from the rest of the sentence with a pair of matching punctuation marks. We already have a dash at the beginning of the supplement, so we need to add a dash at the end of the supplement to match. Choice C is incorrect. This doesn't complete the text in a way that conforms to the conventions of Standard English. "A combination of fiction and memoir, poetry and prose" is a nonessential supplement, so it needs to be set off from the rest of the sentence with a pair of matching punctuation marks. We already have a dash at the beginning of the supplement, so we need to add a dash at the end of the supplement to match.

▼ 2.4 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The comma after "(13C)" pairs with the comma after "isotope" to separate the supplementary element "carbon-13 (13C)" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element defines the "rare carbon isotope," and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element "carbon-13 (13C)" from the rest of the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element "carbon-13 (13C)" from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element "carbon-13 (13C)" from the rest of the sentence. The comma after "carbon-13" isn't necessary because the parentheses around "13C" already separate this element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.5 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The comma after "taxation" pairs with the comma after "that" to separate the supplementary element "through trade and centralized taxation" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to identify the funding source of the Mauryan economy, and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because a colon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a dash can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.6 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The comma after "newts" pairs with the comma after "instance" to separate the supplementary element "for instance" from the rest of the sentence. The supplementary element appears between the prepositional phrase ("In⋯newts") and the main clause of the sentence ("you⋯*orientalis*") and signals that the sentence is presenting an example of how keys and values function in JSON files.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a sentence fragment ("In a JSON file storing data about fire belly newts"). Choice C is incorrect because a colon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element "for instance" from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because a semicolon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element "for instance" from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.7 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma and the coordinating conjunction "and" to join the first main clause ("He⋯1680") and the second main clause ("as⋯time").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

▼ 2.8 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a subject and a verb. No punctuation is needed when, as in this case, a subject ("Her portrait of novelist Zadie Smith") is immediately followed by a main verb ("is displayed").

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

▼ 2.9 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon to correctly join the first main clause ("The Mission⋯parks") and the second main clause that begins with "it."

Choice A is incorrect. When coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

▼ 2.10 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation within two coordinated noun phrases. When, as in this case, a noun phrase ("the country's millions of miles of waterways") is coordinated with another noun phrase ("the fact") followed by an integrated relative clause ("that the volume…time"), no punctuation is needed.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed.

▼ 2.11 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period after "walls" is used correctly to mark the boundary between the first sentence ("In…walls") and the second sentence ("With⋯techniques"), which starts with a supplementary phrase.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("In…walls" and "with…paintings") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice C is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "so" can't be used in this way to join sentences.

▼ 2.12 — C

Choice C is the best answer. A comma is the appropriate way to link the dependent clause “While…not” and the independent clause that follows.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. “While…not” is a dependent clause, which must be separated from the independent clause that follows with some sort of punctuation. Choice B is incorrect. This choice creates a sentence fragment. “While one requires oxygen and one does not” isn’t an independent clause, so it can’t stand alone as a complete sentence. Choice D is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error. “While one requires oxygen and one does not” isn’t an independent clause, so it can’t be linked to the clause that follows with a semicolon.

▼ 2.13 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The word “falling” occurs in the middle of a clause and isn’t part of a supplement, so we don’t need any punctuation after it. We can see this more clearly if we simplify the rest of the sentence: “The reason seeds appear to float while falling is that their plumes enhance drag.” .

Choice A is incorrect. This doesn’t complete the text in a way that conforms to the conventions of Standard English. The word “falling” occurs in the middle of a clause and isn’t part of a supplement, so we don’t need any punctuation after it. We can see this more clearly if we simplify the sentence: “The reason seeds appear to float while falling is that their plumes enhance drag.” . Choice B is incorrect. This doesn’t complete the text in a way that conforms to the conventions of Standard English. The word “falling” occurs in the middle of a clause and isn’t part of a supplement, so we don’t need any punctuation after it. We can see this more clearly if we simplify the sentence: “The reason seeds appear to float while falling is that their plumes enhance drag.” . Choice C is incorrect. This doesn’t complete the text in a way that conforms to the conventions of Standard English. The word “falling” occurs in the middle of a clause and isn’t part of a supplement, so we don’t need any punctuation after it. We can see this more clearly if we simplify the sentence: “The reason seeds appear to float while falling is that their plumes enhance drag.” .

▼ 2.14 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The dash after “Springs” pairs with the dash after “earth” to separate the supplementary element “in this case, the porous rocks of the hills around Hot Springs” from the rest of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because a colon can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because a comma can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.15 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon in a conventional way to join the first main clause ("It is…ones") and the second main clause ("even so…needs"). Furthermore, the placement of the semicolon after "ones" indicates that the supplementary phrase "even so" modifies the following clause ("the reawakening…needs"), resulting in the most logical and grammatically complete sentence. With this punctuation, the sentence logically indicates that the recent interest in an old technology like steam engines is despite the fact that technological change typically seeks out new technologies.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a confusing and illogical sentence. Placing the semicolon after "so" indicates that the supplementary element "even so" modifies the first clause of the sentence, which doesn't make sense in this context. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. It fails to mark the boundary between the two main clauses with appropriate punctuation. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join the two main clauses of the sentence.

▼ 2.16 — B

Choice B is the best answer. Both clauses in this sentence could stand alone as complete sentences, which means they are both independent clauses. This choice uses a comma plus a coordinating conjunction to link them together, which is one of the correct ways to link two independent clauses.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice results in a run-on sentence error. Both clauses in this sentence could stand alone as complete sentences, which means they are both independent clauses. A comma by itself is not enough punctuation to link two independent clauses. Choice C is incorrect. This choice results in a run-on sentence error. Both clauses in this sentence could stand alone as complete sentences, which means they are both independent clauses. Independent clauses can only be linked in a few ways, including with a comma plus a coordinating conjunction. This choice uses the coordinating conjunction "and,"

but it is missing the comma beforehand. Choice D is incorrect. This choice results in a run-on sentence error. Both clauses in this sentence could stand alone as complete sentences, which means they are both independent clauses. Independent clauses need to have certain kinds of punctuation marks between them. This choice doesn't use any punctuation between the two clauses.

▼ 2.17 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The comma after "falsework" pairs with the comma after "supports" to separate the supplementary element "a construction system known as falsework" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to clarify the term "these temporary supports," and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because a semicolon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplemental element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because a colon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.18 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The conventions being tested are the use of punctuation and verb forms within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the main clause ("This...dance") and the supplementary element ("showcasing...world") that provides additional information about what the collaboration accomplished. Moreover, the nonfinite present participle "showcasing" is used correctly to form a supplementary element that modifies the main clause ("this...dance"), describing what the collaboration demonstrated about stylistic diversity and creative innovation in the dance world.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Adding the subject "it" and the finite verb "showcased" results in a second main clause ("it...world"), and a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "which." Choice D is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "showcasing."

▼ 2.19 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a dash after “cooperation” to pair with the dash after “that” to separate the supplementary element “assuming solar panel installers’ cooperation” from the rest of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because a comma can’t be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a colon can’t be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplemental element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.20 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("What⋯vapor") and another ("With⋯point").

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("What⋯vapor" and "with⋯point") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice D is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can’t be used in this way to join sentences.

▼ 2.21 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The comma after "sisters" pairs with the comma after "*Butterflies*" to separate the supplementary element "a fictionalized account of the lives of the Mirabal sisters" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to describe the novel *In the Time of the Butterflies*, and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because a comma and conjunction can’t be used in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.22 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma and the coordinating conjunction "and" to join the first main clause ("This idea⋯paradox") and the second main clause ("research⋯retention").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice D is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction, not after it.

▼ 2.23 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a semicolon to join the first main clause ("One⋯(BEC)") and the second main clause ("Dutch⋯halt").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. Without a comma preceding it, a conjunction can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 2.24 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between two main clauses. "Aibonito is well known for its lush greenery" and "this distinction has earned it the fitting nickname⋯" are both complete main clauses; a semicolon correctly joins them while signaling a close logical connection.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice C is incorrect. When coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction.

▼ 2.25 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a supplementary phrase and a main clause. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the supplementary phrase (“powered⋯day”), which describes how the LEDs are powered, and the main clause (“the blinking⋯night”).

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the supplementary phrase and the main clause with appropriate punctuation. Furthermore, placing commas around the phrase “by solar panels” suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn’t the case. Choice B is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the supplementary phrase and the main clause with appropriate punctuation. Choice D is incorrect. Placing commas around the phrase “collected by solar panels during the day˝ suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn’t the case.

▼ 2.26 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon in a conventional way to join the first main clause ("The measurement...moved") and the second main clause ("for example...second").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a coordinating conjunction, a comma can’t be used in this way to join the two main clauses ("The measurement⋯moved" and "for example⋯second"). Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can’t be used in this way to join the two main clauses ("The measurement⋯moved" and "one unit⋯second"). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses ("The measurement⋯moved" and "one unit⋯second") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 2.27 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between two supplementary phrases following the coordinate clause (“but she⋯mycology”). This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the supplementary noun phrase (“the study of fungi”) that defines the term “mycology” and the supplementary participial phrase (“producing...London”) that provides additional information about the extent to which Potter dedicated herself to mycology.

Choice A is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join two supplementary phrases following a coordinate clause. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "producing." Choice C is incorrect. The lack of punctuation results in a sentence that illogically suggests that the study of fungi is producing more than 350 paintings.

▼ 2.28 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The dash after "stratigraphy" pairs with the dash after "(strata)" to separate the supplementary element "the analysis of Earth's sediment layers (strata)" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to define the term "stratigraphy," and the pair of dashes indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice B is incorrect because a parenthesis can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a colon can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because a comma can't be paired with a dash in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.29 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. The semicolon is correctly used to join the first main clause ("To humans⋯prey") and the second main clause ("rather⋯approach"). Further, the comma after the adverb "rather" is correctly used to separate the adverb from the main clause ("the brightly⋯approach") it modifies, logically indicating that the information in this clause (how the spider's behavior appears to humans) is contrary to the information in the previous clause (how the spider's behavior does not appear to humans).

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without appropriate punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice C is incorrect. Placing the comma between the first main clause "To humans⋯prey" and the adverb "rather" illogically indicates that the information in the first main clause is contrary to what came before, which doesn't make sense in this context.

▼ 2.30 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma and the coordinating conjunction "and" to join the first main clause ("Featuring...1950s") and the second main clause ("given...successful").

Choice B is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

▼ 2.31 — D

Choice D is the best answer. No punctuation should separate the verb "unearthed" and its objects (i.e, what was "unearthed"): "knives, horseshoes, wool tunics, and thousands of other artifacts."

Choice A is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error, separating the verb "unearthed" from its objects (i.e, what was "unearthed") with a colon. Choice B is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error, separating the verb "unearthed" from its objects (i.e, what was "unearthed") with a comma. Choice C is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error, separating the verb "unearthed" from its objects (i.e, what was "unearthed") with a dash.

▼ 2.32 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses. This choice correctly uses a comma and the coordinating conjunction "but" to join the first main clause ("Materials⋯Ru") and the second main clause ("the alloy⋯NiCoCr").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

▼ 2.33 — D

Choice D is the best answer. No punctuation should separate the subject of the sentence (“the Huntington Library in California”) from its verb (“received”).

Choice A is incorrect. No punctuation should separate the subject of the sentence (“the Huntington Library in California”) from its verb (“received”). Choice B is incorrect. No punctuation should separate the subject of the sentence (“the Huntington Library in California”) from its verb (“received”). Choice C is incorrect. No punctuation should separate the subject of the sentence (“the Huntington Library in California”) from its verb (“received”).

▼ 2.34 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The comma appropriately separates the nonessential descriptive aside "such as⋯scene" from the independent clause "Theaters were⋯movie." Since the descriptive example of roses isn’t necessary for the sentence to function, it needs to be set off with punctuation.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice results in a run-on sentence. Since the example of roses isn’t necessary for the sentence to function, the descriptive aside "such as⋯scene" needs to be separated from the preceding independent clause with some sort of punctuation. Choice B is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error. A semicolon can only be used to separate two independent clauses, but "such⋯scene" is not an independent clause and couldn’t stand on its own as a sentence. Choice C is incorrect. This choice results in a sentence fragment. The descriptive aside "Such⋯scene" is not an independent clause and can’t stand on its own as a sentence.

▼ 2.35 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and an enumerated series. In this choice, a colon is correctly used after the main clause (“Since…periods”) to introduce the series identifying the three primary periods of ancient Egyptian history.

Choice A is incorrect because placing a period after “periods” results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with “the Old Kingdom.” Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can’t be used in this way to introduce a series. A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses or to separate items in a complex series, neither of which is the case here. Choice D is incorrect because a comma is not conventionally used to mark the boundary between the main clause (“Since…periods”) and an enumerated series (“the Old Kingdom…(1550–1100 BCE)”) that contains internal

commas. Using a comma in this way creates ambiguity about which commas separate elements in the series and which mark other boundaries in the sentence, making the colon the best choice.

▼ 2.36 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a supplementary element within a sentence. The comma after "method" pairs with the comma after the closing parenthesis to separate the supplementary element "called ELISA (enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay)" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to identify the name of Engvall and Perlmann's method, and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because an opening parenthesis can't be paired with a comma to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice B is incorrect because a dash can't be paired with a comma to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.37 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a verb and a preposition. When, as in this case, a verb ("is added") is immediately followed by a preposition ("whenever"), no punctuation is needed.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the verb and the preposition. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the verb and the preposition. Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the verb and the preposition.

▼ 2.38 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The comma after "1804" pairs with the comma after "amendment" to separate the supplementary element "ratified in 1804" from the rest of the sentence. This supplementary element functions to provide additional information on the term "12th amendment," and the pair of commas indicates that this element could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because a dash can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because a colon can't be paired with a comma in this way to separate the supplementary element from the rest of the sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplemental element from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.39 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a subject and a verb. When, as in this case, a subject ("Calida Garcia Rawles") is immediately followed by a verb ("was"), no punctuation is needed.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

▼ 2.40 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use and punctuation of a relative clause. This choice correctly uses the relative pronoun "that" and no punctuation to create an integrated relative clause that provides essential information about the noun phrase ("graffiti-like scribbles") that it modifies.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the integrated relative clause beginning with "that often" and the noun phrase that it modifies ("graffiti-like scribbles"). Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the integrated relative clause beginning with "that often" and the noun phrase that it modifies ("graffiti-like scribbles"). Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the integrated relative clause beginning with "that often" and the noun phrase that it modifies ("graffiti-like scribbles").

▼ 2.41 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. In this choice, the colon correctly introduces the series of goals held by the 1919 Inter-Allied Women's Conference.

Choice B is incorrect because placing a period after "threefold" results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "To." Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The main clause ("The conference's goals were threefold") and

the series supplement ("to⋯rights") are fused without punctuation. Choice D is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to introduce a series. A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses, whereas a colon is conventionally used to introduce a series, making the colon the better choice in this context.

▼ 2.42 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of elements in a complex series. It's conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after "return" is conventionally used to separate the first item ("*The Siege of Thebes...*return") and the second item ("*The Tale of Beryn...*tourists") in the series of tales. Moreover, the semicolon after "return" matches the semicolon used later to separate the second item and the third item ("and *The Ploughman's Tale...*work") in the series.

Choice A is incorrect because placing a period after "return" results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "*The Tale of Beryn*." Choice B is incorrect because it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the first item and the second item in the complex series. Choice D is incorrect because a comma after "return" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second and third items in the series.

▼ 2.43 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("For⋯work") and another ("That⋯parchment").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("For⋯work" and "that⋯parchment") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice D is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join sentences.

▼ 2.44 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of a restrictive coordinated noun phrase. No punctuation is needed within or around the coordinated noun phrase "researchers Roberto Scandone and Christopher Kilburn" because it would create an illogical separation between the noun "researchers" and the coordinated noun phrase "Roberto Scandone and Christopher Kilburn."

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Placing a pair of commas around the coordinated noun phrase “Roberto Scandone and Christopher Kilburn” creates an illogical separation between the noun “researchers” and the aforementioned coordinated noun phrase. In this case, it illogically suggests that researchers in general bear the specific names Roberto Scandone and Christopher Kilburn. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the noun “researchers” and the coordinated noun phrase “Roberto Scandone and Christopher Kilburn.” Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed within the coordinated noun phrase “Roberto Scandone and Christopher Kilburn.”

▼ 2.45 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and a participial phrase. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the main clause (“Epicurus…‘soul’”) and the participial phrase (“positing… absence”) that provides additional information about how Epicurus defined pleasure.

Choice B is incorrect because a colon can’t be used in this way to join a main clause and a participial phrase. Choice C is incorrect because a semicolon can’t be used in this way to join a main clause and a participial phrase. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with “positing.”

▼ 2.46 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The conventions being tested are punctuation use between titles and proper nouns and between verbs and integrated quotations. No punctuation is needed to set off the proper noun “Stina Chyn” from the title that describes Chyn, “critic.” Because “Stina Chyn” is essential information identifying the “critic,” no punctuation is necessary. Further, no punctuation is needed between the verb “claims” and the following quotation because the quotation is integrated into the structure of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed before or after the proper noun “Stina Chyn.” Setting the critic’s name off with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn’t the case. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed before or after the proper noun “Stina Chyn.” Setting the critic’s name off with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn’t the case. Additionally, no punctuation is needed between “claims” and the integrated quotation. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the verb “claims” and its subject, “critic Stina Chyn.” Additionally, no punctuation is needed between the verb “claims” and the integrated quotation.

▼ 2.47 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the main clause ("Recently…supposed") and the supplementary element ("a finding…Paleolithic") that provides additional information about the implications of the Neronian tool discovery.

Choice A is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join the main clause ("Recently…supposed") and the supplementary element ("a finding…Paleolithic"). Choice B is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "a finding." Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The main clause ("Recently…supposed") and the supplementary element ("a finding…Paleolithic") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 2.48 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("In⋯*Panchali*") and another ("A quiet⋯time"). The phrase beginning with "a quiet" modifies the subject of the next sentence, "Ray's film."

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences.

▼ 2.49 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period after "tombs" is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("Archaeologist…tombs") and another ("Built…nature").

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences. Choice C is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join the two sentences. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("Archaeologist…tombs" and "Built…nature") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 2.50 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a main clause and two supplementary elements. In this choice, the commas after “nickname” and “however” are correctly used to separate the supplementary adverb “however” from the main clause (“Scott-Heron⋯nickname”) on one side and the supplementary participial phrase (“feeling⋯bluesologist”) on the other.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the supplementary adverb “however” and the supplementary phrase (“feeling⋯bluesologist”). Choice B is incorrect because a semicolon can’t be used in this way to join the supplementary adverb “however” and the supplementary phrase (“feeling⋯bluesologist”). Choice D is incorrect because a semicolon can’t be used in this way to join the main clause (“Scott-Heron⋯ nickname”) and the supplementary word and phrase (“however” and “feeling⋯bluesologist”). Moreover, placing the semicolon after “nickname” illogically signals that the following information (Scott-Heron’s feeling that the nickname didn’t encapsulate his devotion to the blues tradition) is contrary to the information in the previous clause (Scott-Heron’s resistance to the nickname).

▼ 2.51 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The clause “Like an Elvis impersonator⋯real thing” and the clause “it is⋯look-alike” are both independent clauses, so making them into two separate sentences is grammatically correct.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. The clause “Like an Elvis impersonator⋯real thing” and the clause “it is⋯look-alike” are both independent clauses, so they need to be separated with at least a comma + a coordinating conjunction. This choice provides the coordinating conjunction “but,” but it’s missing a comma. Choice B is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. The clause “Like an Elvis impersonator⋯real thing” and the clause “it is⋯look-alike” are both independent clauses, so they need to be separated with a semicolon, a colon, a dash, a period, or a comma + a coordinating conjunction. Choice C is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. The clause “Like an Elvis impersonator⋯real thing” and the clause “it is⋯look-alike” are both independent clauses, so they need to be separated with at least a comma + a coordinating conjunction. This choice provides a comma, but it’s missing a coordinating conjunction.

▼ 2.52 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is colon use within a sentence. A colon used in this way introduces information that illustrates or explains information that has come before it. In this case, the colon introduces the following explanation of why some roundworms in the Southern Hemisphere move in the opposite direction of Earth's magnetic field.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two long independent clauses ("Researchers…food" and "in…sources") such as these. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two clauses ("Researchers…food" and "in…sources") are fused without punctuation. Furthermore, the conjunction "while" fails to indicate that what follows is an explanation of why some roundworms in the Southern Hemisphere move in the opposite direction of Earth's magnetic field. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two clauses ("Researchers…food" and "in…sources") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 2.53 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon in a conventional way to join the first main clause ("In many…rare") and the second main clause ("in some…common") in this sentence.

Choice A is incorrect. Joining the first main clause ("In many…rare") and the second main clause ("in some...common") with the conjunction "and" conflicts with the use of "however" later in the sentence, resulting in a confusing and illogical sentence. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 2.54 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a subject and a verb. When, as in this case, a subject ("her 2019 novel *Gingerbread*") is immediately followed by a verb ("offers"), no punctuation is needed.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

▼ 2.55 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within and between sentences. In this choice, the colon correctly introduces the name of the instrument (the flute) that novel audio technologies allowed to be added to jazz and swing. In addition, the period is used to correctly mark the boundary between one sentence ("In⋯ flute") and another ("A relatively⋯greats").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses ("In⋯quiet instrument" and "its⋯greats"). Choice B is incorrect. In standard English, it's unconventional to form a sentence in this way with two uncoordinated subjects ("the flute" and "its full range of sound"), and the lack of a clear main subject results in an awkwardly constructed and confusing sentence. Choice C is incorrect. In standard English, it's unconventional to form an independent clause in this way with two uncoordinated subjects ("the flute" and "its full range of sound"), and the lack of a clear main subject results in an awkwardly constructed and confusing clause.

▼ 2.56 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon in a conventional way to join the first main clause ("Gitlin's⋯content") and the second main clause beginning with a supplementary phrase ("in⋯audiences"). Further, placing a comma after "era" separates the supplementary phrase "in that era" from the rest of the main clause that follows ("even⋯audiences").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Further, this choice fails to mark the boundary between the supplementary phrase "in that era" and the rest of the main clause that follows ("even⋯audiences"). Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses ("Gitlin's⋯content" and "in⋯audiences") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

▼ 2.57 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence (“The Balkan…three”) and another (“Known…chairperson”). While the supplementary element (“known…Croats”) could logically be attached to either the first main clause (“The Balkan…three”) or the second main clause (“these elected…chairperson”), end-

of-sentence punctuation is needed to indicate to which sentence the supplementary element belongs.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. In this choice, the first sentence, consisting of a main clause (“The Balkan…three”) and supplementary element (“known…Croats”), is incorrectly joined with a second main clause (“these elected…chairperson”) using a comma. A comma can’t be used in this way to join two sentences. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. In this choice, the first sentence, consisting of a main clause (“The Balkan…three”) and a relative clause (“who are…Croats”), is incorrectly joined with a second main clause (“these elected…chairperson”) using a comma. A comma can’t be used in this way to join two sentences. Additionally, this choice omits the comma needed after “three” to mark the beginning of the supplementary relative clause (“who are known…Croats”). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. In this choice, the first sentence, consisting of a main clause (“The Balkan…three”) and a supplementary relative clause (“who are…Croats”), is incorrectly joined with a second main clause (“these elected…chairperson”) using a comma. A comma can’t be used in this way to join two sentences.

▼ 2.58 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed between the proper noun “Yugang Sun” and the title that describes Sun, “chemistry professor.” Furthermore, no punctuation is needed after “Sun” because “chemistry professor Yugang Sun and his colleagues at Temple University” functions as the coordinated subject of the sentence, and together Sun and colleagues performed the action of developing a new approach to producing iron nanoparticles.

Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the proper noun “Yugang Sun” and the coordinated noun phrase “and his colleagues at Temple University.” Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed before or after the proper noun “Yugang Sun.” Setting off the professor’s name with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn’t the case. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the title “chemistry professor” and the proper noun “Yugang Sun.”

▼ 2.59 — A

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of elements in a complex series. It's conventional to use a semicolon to separate items in a complex series with internal punctuation, and in this choice, the semicolon after "significance" is conventionally used to separate the first item ("intricate...significance") and the second item ("depictions...animals") in the series of common elements found in Celtic art. Moreover, the semicolon after "significance" matches the semicolon used later to separate the second item ("depictions...animals") and the third item ("and...accents") in the series.

Choice B is incorrect because a comma after "significance" doesn't match the semicolon used later to separate the second and third items in the series ("depictions...animals" and "and...accents"). Choice C is incorrect because a colon can't be used in this way to separate items in a complex series. Choice D is incorrect because placing a period after "significance" results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "depictions."

▼ 2.60 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "though" from the preceding main clause ("They are hardly pristine") and uses a semicolon to join the two main clauses ("They⋯though" and "many⋯objects"). Further, placing the semicolon after "though" indicates that the information in the preceding main clause (chondrites are far from pristine) is contrary to what might be assumed from the information in the previous sentence (chondrites have been generally unaltered by their environment).

Choice A is incorrect because placing the comma after "pristine" and using "though" as a subordinating conjunction illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause (many chondrites have experienced damage) is contrary to the information in the previous clause (chondrites are far from pristine). Choice C is incorrect because placing the semicolon after "pristine" illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause (many chondrites have experienced damage) is contrary to the information in the previous clause (chondrites are far from pristine). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, the comma after "though" can't be used in this way to join two main clauses.

▼ 2.61 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed to offset the proper noun "Yuree Lee" from the title "plant cell biologist" that describes Lee.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed around the proper noun "Yuree Lee." Setting the phrase off with punctuation suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case.

▼ 2.62 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one sentence ("Philosopher…aesthetics") and another ("As…formalist"). The long adverbial element "as evidenced…itself" modifies the content in the following clause to support the claim that Kivy's approach was formalist.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("Philosopher…aesthetics" and "As⋯formalist") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice B is incorrect. Without a comma preceding it, the conjunction "and" can't be used in this way to join sentences. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences.

▼ 2.63 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. The comma after "observation" pairs with the comma after "however" to separate the supplementary adverb "however" from the rest of the sentence, which consists of a main clause ("Lai…observation") followed by a participial phrase ("recommending…study").

Choice A is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join the main clause ("Lai…observation") and the participial phrase ("recommending…study") that follows the supplementary adverb "however." A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses, and "recommending…study" isn't a main clause. Choice C is incorrect because placing a period after "observation" results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "however." Choice D is incorrect because a semicolon can't be used in this way to join the main clause ("Lai…however") and the participial phrase ("recommending…study") that follows. A semicolon is conventionally used to join two main clauses, and "recommending…study" isn't a main clause.

▼ 2.64 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between sentences. In this choice, the period is used correctly to mark the boundary between one

sentence ("In modern⋯audience") and another ("To do⋯performance").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a rhetorically unacceptable sentence fragment beginning with "as." Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The sentences ("In modern⋯audience" and "To do⋯performance") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to mark the boundary between sentences.

▼ 2.65 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use and punctuation of an integrated relative clause. In this choice, the relative pronoun "that" is used to create an integrated relative clause that modifies the preceding noun phrase "a conceptual framework for pattern formation." No punctuation is necessary between the noun phrase and the relative clause because the relative clause is supplying essential information about the framework.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the noun phrase ("a conceptual⋯formation") and the integrated relative clause beginning with "that." Choice B is incorrect because it results in a confusing and ungrammatical sentence. Choice D is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. A semicolon is used to join two main clauses or items in a complex series, and what follows "formation" is neither of these.

▼ 2.66 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed to set off the proper noun "Wakako Yamauchi" from the title that describes Yamauchi, "pioneering playwright." Because "Wakako Yamauchi" is essential information identifying the "pioneering playwright," no punctuation is necessary.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed before or after the proper noun "Wakako Yamauchi." Setting the playwright's name off with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the title "pioneering playwright" and the proper noun "Wakako Yamauchi." Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the proper noun "Wakako Yamauchi" and the verb "compares."

▼ 2.67 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the punctuation of supplementary elements within a sentence. The comma after "described" separates the first supplementary element ("both of interviewees and the items they described") from the second supplementary element ("from hair to grass to sculptures"). Furthermore, the dash after "sculptures" pairs with the dash after "photographs" to separate these two supplementary elements from the rest of the sentence. The pair of dashes, which operate at a higher organizing level than the comma, indicates that the elements between the dashes function together—in this case, the second supplement ("from…sculptures") describes the range of items mentioned in the first supplement—and could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to appropriately punctuate the supplementary elements in the sentence. A dash is needed after "sculptures" to separate the supplementary elements ("both…sculptures") from the rest of the sentence. Choice C is incorrect because it fails to appropriately punctuate the supplementary elements in the sentence. The two supplementary elements "both…described" and "from…sculptures" function together to describe the photographs, and placing a dash between them would make this relationship less clear, suggesting that the supplement "both...described" is a standalone element that could be removed without affecting the grammatical coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case. Choice D is incorrect because it fails to appropriately punctuate the supplementary elements in the sentence. A colon isn't conventionally used in this way to separate a supplementary element ("from hair to grass to sculptures") from the noun phrase it is modifying ("items they described"). Additionally, a dash is needed after "sculptures" to separate the supplementary elements ("both…sculptures") from the rest of the sentence.

▼ 2.68 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between coordinates in a sentence. The two elements "how…regions" and "what…ocean" work together as coordinates to complete the description of what the team was able to determine. Because there are only two coordinates in this case (as opposed to a series of three or more), no punctuation is needed between them.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinates "how… regions" and "what…ocean." Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinates "how…regions" and "what…ocean." Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the coordinates "how…regions" and "what…ocean."

▼ 2.69 — B

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of a colon within a sentence. In this choice, the colon correctly introduces the following description of how the painting makes use of the entire visual light spectrum by depicting a rainbow-hued swimmer.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The main clauses ("Like⋯ spectrum" and "sporting⋯water") are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The main clauses ("Like⋯ spectrum" and "while⋯water") are fused without punctuation. Furthermore, the conjunction "while" fails to indicate that what follows is a description of how the painting makes use of the entire visual light spectrum. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a logically confusing sentence. The conjunction "while," which suggests that what follows is occurring at the same time as or despite what came before, fails to indicate that what follows is a description of how the painting makes use of the entire visual light spectrum.

▼ 2.70 — C

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of main clauses within a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma and the coordinating conjunction "and" to join the first main clause ("In 1919 Larrazolo was elected governor of New Mexico") and the second main clause ("in 1928 he became the nation's first Hispanic US Senator").

Choice A is incorrect because when coordinating two longer main clauses such as these, it's conventional to use a comma before the coordinating conjunction. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.

▼ 2.71 — D

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within a sentence. This choice uses a semicolon in a conventional way to join the first main clause ("That the...involved") and the second main clause ("establishing...divisive"). Further, the semicolon is the most appropriate choice when joining two separate, parallel statements, such as here, where the information following the semicolon contrasts with the information before.

Choice A is incorrect because placing a colon after "involved" illogically indicates that the information in the second main clause (the precise location was the subject of disagreement) explains or amplifies the information in the previous main clause (the general location was agreed upon by all). Instead, the information in the second clause contrasts with the previous information. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Without a conjunction following it, a comma can’t be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two main clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction.